CANKILI II

The Crown & The Fall
Complete story for Components 2 and 3

Purpose: A ready-to-use narrative reference for the Component 2 interactive storybook and the Component 3 anime animation, with historical context, scene-by-scene storytelling, and a source list.

Component 2: Part I - The Crown. Nineteen screens, presented in traditional and contemporary comic styles.

Component 3: Part II - The Fall. Proposed animated continuation depicting the 1619 Portuguese conquest, Cankili II's capture and the kingdom's legacy.

Historical accuracy note: Broad historical events are researched, but the staging of court meetings, messenger scenes, individual gestures, quoted dialogue, battle choreography and modern heroic imagery are artistic reconstructions. There is no reliably authenticated portrait of Cankili II.

The historical story in brief

In the early seventeenth century, the Jaffna Kingdom in northern Sri Lanka faced increasing pressure from the Portuguese, whose power was expanding around the island. After the death of ruler Ethirimana Cinkam, the royal succession became contested. Cankili II (also known as Sangili Kumaran) came to power amid conflict in 1617. His position was disputed by rivals, and his period of rule was marked by internal unrest and Portuguese interference.

Cankili II sought support from the Thanjavur Nayak kingdom in South India. Military assistance associated with the commander Varunakulattan (also called Khem Nayak in some accounts) helped him resist opponents. In 1619, Portuguese forces commanded by Filipe de Oliveira ultimately overcame his kingdom. Cankili II was captured and taken to Goa, where he was later executed. The conquest ended the independent monarchy in Jaffna, though resistance and memory of the kingdom survived.

Important complexity: Cankili II should not be presented as a purely unchallenged or universally supported hero. Historians also discuss his violent and disputed accession. The contemporary superhero version is deliberately a creative adaptation.

Narrative structure

PART I: THE CROWN	PART II: THE FALL
Component 2 | 19 digital storybook screens	Component 3 | Proposed 6 animation sequences
Jaffna -> succession dispute -> crown -> political pressure -> Thanjavur -> Portuguese threat -> legacy/heroic reinterpretation -> cliffhanger	Ships and troops approach -> defensive preparations -> confrontation -> defeat and capture -> removal to Goa -> remembrance

COMPONENT 2 - PART I: THE CROWN

The storybook opens in Jaffna, explores the royal succession and changing political environment, and ends immediately before the decisive conflict. The same underlying events are shown in two visual versions: a traditional illustrated narrative and a contemporary anime comic with imagined dialogue.

01. Jaffna Before the Fall

The story begins in early seventeenth-century Jaffna. Villages, palmyra trees, religious centres and maritime routes suggest a kingdom with its own political and cultural life. Yet an uncertain future is approaching.

Storyboard direction: Establish a calm opening with a Tamil village and coast. This image is a cultural reconstruction, not an exact period photograph.

02. Across the Waters

Portuguese influence expands around Sri Lanka. Ships and traders represent new connections, but also the potential for foreign intervention. The coastal setting now carries a feeling of danger.

Storyboard direction: Show ships on the horizon and worried coastal observers, keeping the king’s appearance consistent.

03. An Empty Throne

After the death of the ruler Ethirimana Cinkam, a succession dispute raises a difficult question: who has the right to rule Jaffna? An empty throne expresses uncertainty and division.

Storyboard direction: Use one prominent throne, two advisers and simple court architecture. The pictured meeting is dramatized.

04. Cankili Appears

Cankili II comes forward in the struggle for royal power. His rise is neither smooth nor unanimously accepted; opposition and conflict surround his claim.

Storyboard direction: Present the approved Cankili character stepping into the court, with conflicting reactions.

05. The Crown

Cankili II establishes his claim to the throne. The crown symbolizes authority, but it also highlights the heavy burden of governing a divided kingdom under foreign pressure.

Storyboard direction: The crown and seated king dominate; avoid implying a documented coronation ceremony.

06. A Divided Court

Members of the court disagree over who should rule and how to respond to outside influence. Rival interests weaken trust in the royal centre.

Storyboard direction: Emphasize expressive advisers and the king. Specific council dialogue is fictional.

07. Pressure on the Kingdom

The struggle for influence intensifies. Unrest, Portuguese involvement and concern for the kingdom's future become more serious. A messenger's warning introduces the mounting danger.

Storyboard direction: Make the message scroll and the characters the primary elements; the messenger encounter is invented staging.

08. Trade and Sea Routes

Jaffna's location across the waters from South India made maritime links important to commerce and political relations. The same routes also created opportunities for outside powers to influence the kingdom.

Storyboard direction: Use merchants, sailors, simple boats and cargo bundles rather than a complex port reconstruction.

09. Across the Palk Strait

Seeking to strengthen his political and military position, Cankili II looks toward the Thanjavur Nayaks across the Palk Strait. Help from South India becomes central to the coming conflict.

Storyboard direction: Show a messenger, a schematic unlabelled map and Cankili discussing support. The dialogue and map meeting are invented.

10. Thanjavur's Court

The story shifts to the Thanjavur Nayak court. Through the fictional scene of envoys presenting a request, viewers learn that Cankili II had connections with and support from Thanjavur.

Storyboard direction: Show the Thanjavur ruler as distinct from Cankili. An exact diplomatic meeting is not established.

PP1 checkpoint: The first ten screens in both traditional and contemporary styles have been storyboarded (20 panels/pages of the planned 38). Screens 11–19 describe the remaining planned story sequence.

11. Aid by Sea

Troops linked to the Thanjavur Nayak ruler arrive to support Cankili II. Varunakulattan, also known in some sources as Khem Nayak, is a key commander associated with this assistance.

Storyboard direction: Focus on the commander, a small group of soldiers and a simple boat; do not invent precise uniform details.

12. The Portuguese Prepare

The Portuguese move from indirect pressure toward a campaign to impose their authority over Jaffna. Military preparations increase the sense that open conflict is close.

Storyboard direction: Use Portuguese officers, a table map and equipment. Treat the exact planning scene as imagined.

13. A Symbol of Resistance

The crown, cloth banner and weapon become symbols of Jaffna's struggle to remain independent. The story's modern heroic imagery begins to emerge alongside the historical narrative.

Storyboard direction: A surul vaal/urumi can be used as stylized symbolism; there is no secure evidence Cankili personally wielded one.

14. Storm on the Horizon

The danger now feels immediate. Coastal lookouts see approaching vessels, and the people of Jaffna understand that an attack is possible.

Storyboard direction: Keep the approaching ships distant and emphasize expressions, silhouettes and warning gestures.

15. The Memory Remains

The story briefly moves forward in time. Although the kingdom is eventually conquered, the memory of its rulers and its history is preserved in cultural narratives and heritage.

Storyboard direction: Use a visual transition to memory and heritage; avoid presenting present-day buildings as exact 1619 structures.

16. Stories Across Generations

An elder tells younger listeners a story of Jaffna’s last king. The scene explores how a historical figure can be remembered differently by later generations.

Storyboard direction: This intergenerational conversation is invented; it conveys the theme of memory.

17. A New Heroic Image

The traditional representation of Cankili II transforms into a colourful contemporary anime interpretation. The shift is explicitly a change of art style, not a historical transformation.

Storyboard direction: Keep recognizable design motifs while making the superhero elements clearly fictional.

18. The Rider

The imagined anime Cankili stands or rides as a heroic symbol. The modern Sangiliyan equestrian statue may inspire the composition, but it does not prove the details of his historical appearance.

Storyboard direction: Use the established red-boots costume, horse and simple silhouette as visual symbols.

19. The Story Continues

The narrative returns to the historical crisis. Portuguese forces approach. Cankili and the defenders face an uncertain struggle; the outcome is not yet shown. The final image is a cliffhanger leading directly into the animation.

Storyboard direction: End with an approaching force and a clear transition card: Part II - The Fall.

COMPONENT 3 - PART II: THE FALL

This is a proposed animation continuation intended to connect with Component 2. It is not a claim about a completed or independently verified animation script. It follows the historical outcome while using staged fictional moments for a clear narrative.

Sequence 1 - The warning becomes real

Begin directly after Storyboard 19. Portuguese forces approach Jaffna. A coastal guard alerts those within the kingdom, while Cankili II and his advisers react to the danger. The threat previously shown only at a distance is now unavoidable.

Animation direction: Suggested visual: quick cuts between ship silhouettes, a running messenger and Cankili's serious expression.

Sequence 2 - Preparing to resist

The king and forces supporting him prepare to face the campaign. Varunakulattan and the Thanjavur connection can be acknowledged as important sources of military assistance, without implying they were present in every fictional shot.

Animation direction: Suggested visual: two or three warriors, raised banner, readying defensive positions, minimal backgrounds.

Sequence 3 - The confrontation of 1619

Portuguese forces under Filipe de Oliveira confront Jaffna's defenders. The animation shows urgency, confusion and resistance through brief, non-graphic combat images. Historical scholarship supports the 1619 conquest, but exact sword duels and shouted orders should be labelled fictional.

Animation direction: Suggested visual: opposing troops, dust, directional movement and brief close-ups rather than a long invented duel.

Sequence 4 - Defeat and capture

The Portuguese defeat the forces defending the Jaffna ruler. Cankili II is captured. The crown or royal banner falls out of frame as a visual metaphor for the loss of power.

Animation direction: Suggested visual: the king surrounded, weapon lowered, royal emblem left behind. Avoid unverified final speeches.

Sequence 5 - Taken to Goa

Cankili II is taken to Goa, where he is later executed. Sources differ on details of the death, including methods or precise dating; for a historically cautious student animation, show his removal to Goa with a restrained text explanation rather than an invented execution scene.

Animation direction: Suggested visual: a ship departing, map transition to Goa, dark fade and informational text.

Sequence 6 - The kingdom falls, the memory remains

The independent monarchy of Jaffna ends with the Portuguese conquest. The closing scene reflects on historical loss and the ways Cankili II has been remembered and reimagined. The modern hero image from Component 2 returns, now explicitly a symbol of memory rather than a literal account.

Animation direction: Suggested visual: vacant throne -> fading royal symbol -> heritage-memory image -> closing title.

Suggested transition text and ending narration

End of Component 2: “The sea carried a warning. Jaffna would soon face its greatest trial.”

Opening of Component 3: “In 1619, the struggle for the Jaffna Kingdom reached a decisive moment. Portuguese forces advanced, and the fate of its ruler and people changed.”

Closing of Component 3: “Cankili II was defeated, and Jaffna’s independent royal rule came to an end. History remembers the conflict; later generations continue to reinterpret its final king.”

All three lines above are original narration written for the project. They are not quotations from historical records.

Historical grounding vs creative interpretation

Historical core

Jaffna Kingdom in the early 1600s; Cankili II’s disputed accession; Portuguese pressure; Thanjavur assistance; the 1619 conquest; Cankili’s capture and transfer to Goa.

Interpretive reconstructions

Palace conversations, exact envoy meetings, messenger warnings, council scenes, arrangements of advisers, individual character gestures and detailed battle choreography.

Clearly fictional adaptations

Anime superhero physique, red boots, dramatic speeches, magical-seeming style transitions, specific horse-riding depiction and symbolic surul vaal.

Historical care points

Cankili I and Cankili II are different rulers. An exact, authenticated portrait of Cankili II is not established. The present Nallur temple facade should not be used as an unqualified 1619 reconstruction. Execution details and dates are inconsistently retold; use cautious wording.

Short project explanation for the PP1 viva

> “My Component 2 is a nineteen-screen interactive digital storybook about Cankili II and the events leading up to the Portuguese conquest of Jaffna. I present the same narrative in two styles: a traditional historically inspired illustration style and a modern anime comic style. The first ten storyboard screens of both versions are complete for PP1. Component 3 is the animated continuation, covering the 1619 campaign, Cankili II’s defeat and capture, the end of independent royal rule and the legacy of the kingdom. I have separated documented historical events from imagined dialogue and character design decisions.”

References and research links

1. De Silva, C. R. (1967), The Portuguese in Ceylon, 1617-1638. SOAS University of London, doctoral thesis.

https://soas-repository.worktribe.com/output/387469/the-portuguese-in-ceylon-1617-1638

2. Pathmanathan, S. (1979), The Kingdom of Jaffna - Propaganda? or History? Sri Lanka Journal of the Humanities 5(1-2), 101-125.

https://ir.lib.pdn.ac.lk/items/c69855ca-8af0-4a57-bee9-9613eb23072b

3. De Queyroz, F., The Temporal and Spiritual Conquest of Ceylon, trans. S. G. Perera (historical Portuguese chronicle; read critically).

https://diglib.natlib.lk/handle/123456789/8024

4. Sri Lankan school history resource: Portuguese presence and conquest of Jaffna (overview; verify edition and page references if cited).

https://govdoc.nyc3.cdn.digitaloceanspaces.com/prod_govdoc/2146/6401763bc9ec2.pdf

Use in the viva: Show these sources alongside design screenshots and explain which scenes are research-informed versus staged fictional moments. The PDF is an original educational retelling, not a substitute for the historical sources.